

GUCCI
OSTERIA

da Massimo Bottura

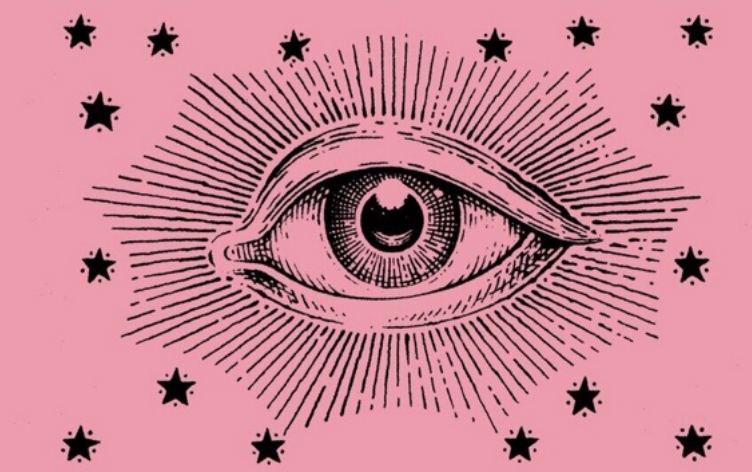


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GUCCI OSTERIA

da Massimo Bottura





BEVERLY HILLS



Massimo Bottura

One of the key figures in the new Italian cultural Renaissance is Massimo Bottura of three Michelin star Osteria Francescana in Modena. He inspired Mattia to free his creativity and evolve his cuisine beyond tradition: to be more imaginative, more open and more inventive.





Bread is Gold

*Rosemary olive bun with white truffle crème
Poppyseed sourdough and cracker served with Normandy butter and Italian burrata*

Insalata di Mare

A seafood salad of clam, calamari, scallop, and prawn, shaved daikon diced cucumber and zucchini, New Zealand tetragonia, lime juice with tomatillo and jalapeño

Spring is Coming

Pickled white asparagus, burrata, buckwheat, seaweed

Risotto Camouflaged as Pizza

Burnt capers as pizza crust, tomato water, sun-dried tomato, basil cream, stracciatella cheese

Cod as Milanese

White miso marinated cod, farmer's market cherry tomato terrine

Coming from the Hills “I Love Rock Climbing”

Barely steamed local white trout, highland lovage oil, sake stock, forage mushrooms, hazelnut crust, freshly shaved black truffle

Patatine Fritte - Our fries don't speak french

Roasted chicken salt, chicken skin, rosemary, served with EVO mayo

So I turn'd to the Garden of Love

Shaved Asian pear, lychee and lychee sorbet, rose infused mochi

Banana, Banana, Bananaaa

Toasted banana ice-cream, banana meringue, cocoa water with cocoa nibs

Modena Cheese Tart

Buckwheat Italian cheese tart with shaved Parmigiano Reggiano, cassis sorbet with Massimo Bottura balsamic vinegar

Mignardise

Vanilla cream puff and mandarin jelly





Gucci Osteria by Massimo Osteria is a hidden gem on the rodeo drive. The dreamy rococo style sunroom immediately transfers me to a renaissance garden of Gucci in Florence. As we are seated at the grandeur marble table, breads are soon offered. In the basket we find flat crackers and poppyseed sourdough, which are paired with a refreshing and light burrata cheese and a luxurious Normandy butter soft enough to melt into a frothy butter bath once it touches the tongue. On another Gucci plate presents two mini rosemary buns paired with a rich earthy white truffle cream.



Rosemary olive bun with white truffle crème

*Poppyseed sourdough and cracker
served with Normandy butter and Italian burrata*





To unfold our a la carte lunch exploration, two refreshing starts soon arrive at the table. The first is a seafood salad dish consisting of a medley of clam, calamari, scallop, and prawn. The seafood medley is mixed with diced cucumber and zucchini as well as lime juice infused with tomatillo and jalapeño. It is then further covered with medallions of daikon radish decorated with tetragonia spinach. The seafood is barely cooked to achieve a more complex amalgamation of flavors which allows you to enjoy both the fresh raw umami and the butterier and sweeter cooked flesh.

Following up the seafood dish is a spring salad comprising pickled white asparagus, burrata, buckwheat, and seaweed. The combination of burrata cheese and buckwheat tuile is very identical to the bread cracker, thus it seems to be almost a redundancy for us. Yet the pickled asparagus sublimated the whole with its appetizing sweet and sour succulence.





“We're going to Beverly Hills to open a pizzeria!” Chef Agazzi will never forget this hilarious joking moment when the legendary chef Massimo Bottura appointed him as the head chef at the new osteria at Beverly Hill. While the Gucci osteria will not abandon its aristocratic temperament, chef Agazzi is restoring the pizzeria scene by creating the “risotto camouflaged as pizza” dish, not only as a play on the pizzeria joke but more significantly as a homage to the infamous camouflage risotto dish created by Massimo himself at his flagship Osteria Francescana. Chef Agazzi managed to turn all the pizza elements into this risotto dish, where we have the sun-dried tomato and tomato jus engulfing the carbohydrate, which is further scented with a fabulous splash of basil cream and a crowning touch of burnt caper mimicking the burning edge of a pizza. A simple dish as such, yet extremely rich in textures and layers of flavors.



As the chef of the second Gucci Osteria, Chef Agazzi takes something from both its predecessor and successor. From Gucci Osteria Florence, the chef inherits the idea of fish in the style of Milan, and from Gucci Osteria Tokyo, the chef learns about the popular technique Saikyo-yaki. Chef Agazzi then combines them and comes up with a dish comprising cod fish marinated in white miso and then fried in the Milanese style. The fish is further elevated by a piece of cherry tomato and cherry tomato water terrine. The crust is so crispy that immediately envelops the fish during the frying process, resulting in an almost steaming procedure that allows the flesh to stay hydrated at max capacity. Here, the uttermost crispy crust meets the ultimate tender flesh, creating a fabulous textural counterpoint. The bright and refreshing white miso bestows an oriental kiss on the cod without depriving the original umami, while the cherry tomato terrine further sublimates the whole with an additional layer of lightness.



The next fish dish is called Coming from the Hills “I Love Rock Climbing.” Chef Agazzi aims to create a quasi-sashimi dish by barely steaming the local white trout fish, allowing the trout to reveal an extreme tenderness comparable to silk tofu. As the name suggests, the ingredients are gems hidden in the woods alongside the climbing path. From the earth, the chef takes forage mushrooms and truffle, and from the highland, the chef harvests the lovage. As a result, the trout is showered with a rare and fully aromatic highland lovage oil in addition to a sophisticated sake wine jus with forage mushrooms. The dish is then finished with a generous scattering of shaved black truffle, elevating the whole with an additional touch of earthiness.



The inner part of the fries, however, is below ideal moisture. It is thus hard to eat without constantly rehydrating my mouth. The rich flavor plus the mayonnaise dip are other factors that prevent me from eating much of the fries. Though mayonnaise is paired with the fries, we ask for ketchup in order to try several different dip combinations. It seems that a mixture of ketchup and mayonnaise is best for this fries dish.

As a fun gesture, I order the fries as a side dish to the cod course, creating a “fish and chips” combination. While the two dishes are not meant to be enjoyed together, and the flavor profiles do not have much in common, the non-french fries dish is still a popular item on the menu to enjoy on its own. Using roasted chicken skins and a salt made from the chicken, the fries are indeed rich in flavor. The rosemary further enriches the flavor by not only adding a touch of herbal aroma but also creating an illusion almost as if the dish is a grilled meat dish.





Comprising a central island of toasted banana ice cream and banana meringue floating on a coconut water lake scented with cocoa nibs, the next dessert “Banana, Banana, Bananaaa” is an ode to banana. The banana center is extremely light in texture that seems to be ephemeral, yet its flavor is deep and prominent enough. The cacao-scented coconut water has a light texture and rich depth as well, singing in perfect harmony with the banana core of the dish.

Moving on to desserts, we first have the “So I turn'd to the Garden of Love” course. The dessert is simply a medley of lychee, lychee sorbet, and rose mochi, capped with shaved Asian pear. A refreshing and light dessert as such is ideal as a palate cleanser. The original flavor of pears and lychee is dominating the whole, while the rose scented mochi adds a layer of subtlety in the background. Just like the name says, it is a refreshing garden filled with pure and innocent romance.





The final dessert course is also the most flavorful one. Consisting of a traditional Modena cheese tart snowed with freshly shaved parmigiano reggiano cheese and a cassis sorbet accented with Massimo Bottura's own balsamic vinegar, the dessert literally screams rich cheesy brininess and creaminess, sharp fruity acidity, and condensed balsamic sourness all at once.

A combination as peculiar as the cassis sorbet with balsamic vinegar may sound creepy for most diners, but the balsamic vinegar is the crowning touch here, as it provides a sophisticated depth to balance the one dimensional fruity acidity of the sorbet. A final tray of mignardise then shows up, calling the end of our lunch. Two simple petit fours such as the vanilla cream puff and the mandarin jelly are unmistakable and popular to end a meal with.

